

$$\frac{15}{4} \div \frac{2}{5}$$

1. Find 15 over 4 divided by 2 over 5.
2. To divide fractions, we multiply by the reciprocal. We only reciprocate the second fraction, and turn division into multiplication at the moment reciprocation happens.
3. So dividing by 2 over 5 turns into multiplying by 5 over 2. Our problem is now 15 over 4 times 5 over 2.
4. To multiply fractions, we multiply straight across (whether we have a common denominator or not). So the numerator is 15 times 5, and the denominator is 4 times 2.
5. Simplifying the numerator and denominator separately, we have 75 over 8.
6. Since 75 and 8 do not share any common factors, this is as simplified as it gets as an improper fraction.
7. In most situations in algebra, we leave our answer like this.
8. If we need to write this as a mixed fraction, 75 divided by 8 gives us 9 with a remainder of 3, so we would have 9 and 3 over 8. Both are correct: 75 over 8 is correct, and 9 and 3 over 8 is also correct.

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